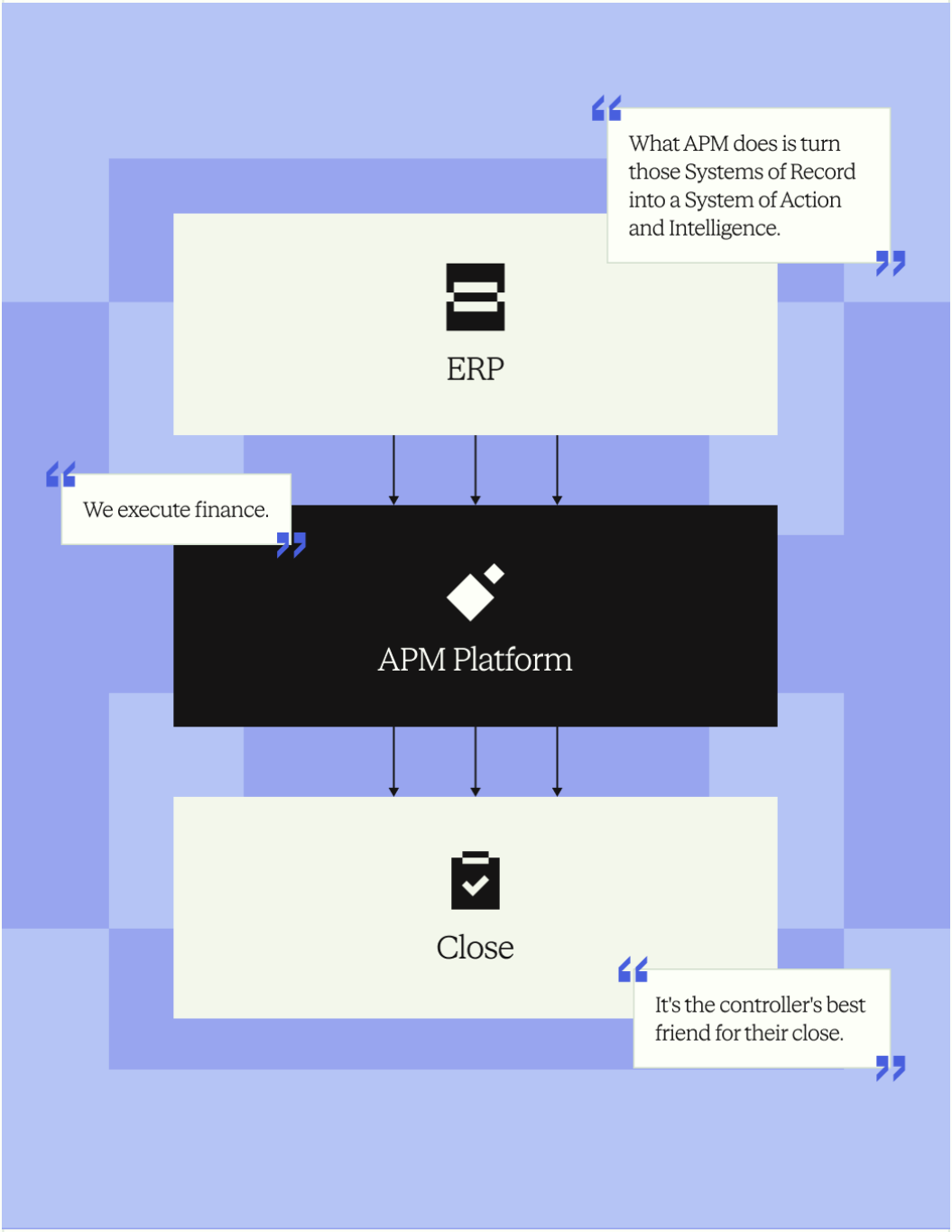
Nominal

The Agentic Performance Management Playbook

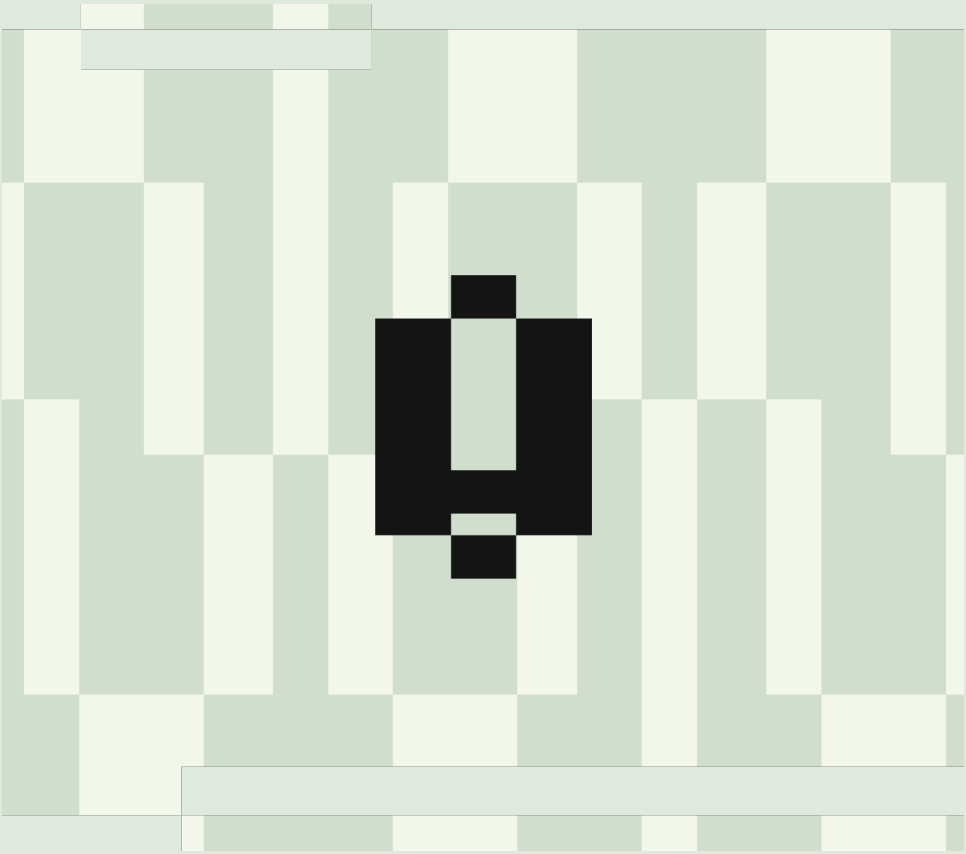
A practical guide to deploying AI in finance with control, governance, and measurable impact, powered by Agentic Performance Management.

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What APM does is turn those Systems of Record into a System of Action and Intelligence.
ERP
We execute finance.
APM Platform
Close
It's the controller's best friend for their close.

Executive Summary



Finance is at an inflection point. Expectations continue to rise. Stakeholders expect faster closes, deeper insights, tighter controls, and audit-ready documentation on demand. The finance talent pool is shrinking. Fewer new CPAs are becoming certified, and many experienced finance professionals are retiring. Complexity is growing, driven

by multi-entity structures, fragmented ERPs, new policies, and external pressures.

The winners in this environment will not be the finance teams that work harder; they will be the teams working smarter. The solution? Agentic Performance Management (APM), an intelligent, coordinated system of specialized AI agents that execute multi-step finance and accounting workflows with audit-ready documentation and control.

APM delivers execution rather than suggestion, a continuous close-ready state, ERP-agnostic, multi-entity scalability, and human-in-the-loop governance. It is transforming the controller's function, moving finance teams from "doers" to "reviewers." With reduced time to close, continuous audit readiness, lower risk, and better decision-quality data, APM is modernizing finance.

This guide gives concrete, actionable strategies to help finance leaders assess and implement APM to build a finance function that scales with confidence. It also provides an evaluation toolkit to help separate true agent-based execution systems from "AI-powered" look-alikes.

As the business context becomes more complex and challenging, APM gives finance leaders a durable competitive advantage. Agentic AI in finance shifts the operating model away from manual workloads and into end-to-end orchestration and completion with a system of action and intelligence.

The New Reality for Finance Leaders

It's no longer a question of "if" finance leaders must implement AI. It's a question of when and how.

Recommended read:

Corporate Finance & Accounting Talent Study 2025 (Controllers Council)

Finance teams are navigating growing complexity and shrinking capacity. More entities, more transactions and more scrutiny. Pressure is building to close faster, analyze deeper, and strengthen controls without adding headcount. Repetitive workflows, error chasing, and audit fire drills constantly pull teams away from bigger-picture strategy and analysis.

At the same time, the accounting and finance talent crunch is intensifying. U.S. accounting degree holders are declining, and the number taking the CPA exam is trending down. Large numbers of experienced finance professionals and CPAs are retiring, exacerbating the accounting talent drought.

The traditional tools in the finance toolbox have hit a ceiling, too. ERPs and EPM platforms help structure data and reporting, but cannot execute. Reconciliations, journal entries, and judgment-heavy steps still require intensive human effort. And while month-end close automation and rules-based tools can accelerate pieces of the process, they

still rely on humans to interpret, verify and complete the work. AI copilots are not enough, either. They can help teams with pieces of the process, but cannot reliably complete end-to-end workflows.

Related post: Agentic AI Will Transform Finance: Here's What CFOs Should Do Now (Gartner)

Agentic Performance Management (APM) is the missing link, a powerful execution engine that allows finance leaders to implement AI with control, clarity, and confidence. APM agents can fully execute complex finance workflows, so finance teams can spend less time on repetitive manual work and more time on strategic analysis and decision-making.

In this APM playbook, you'll find actionable insights on how to leverage agentic finance to increase performance, decrease close time and reduce audit risk. Here are the tools you need to become the smartest person in the room when it comes to AI and finance, and high-impact solutions to the issues faced by finance leaders and teams today.

> "Now we have the opportunity to move finance from a system of records to a system of action and intelligence."
>
> **Guy Lebowitz,**
> Founder and CEO, Nominal

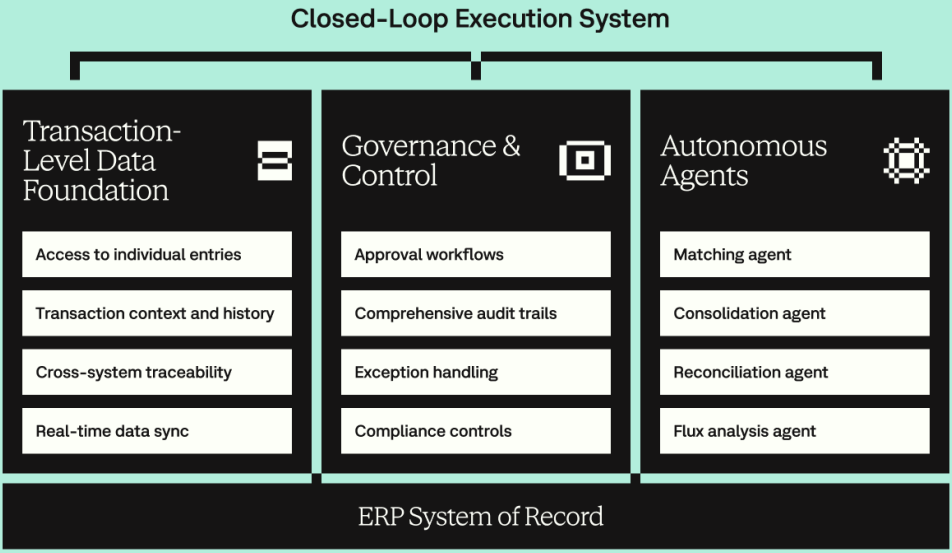
What is Agentic Performance Management?

Agentic Performance Management (APM)

[noun]

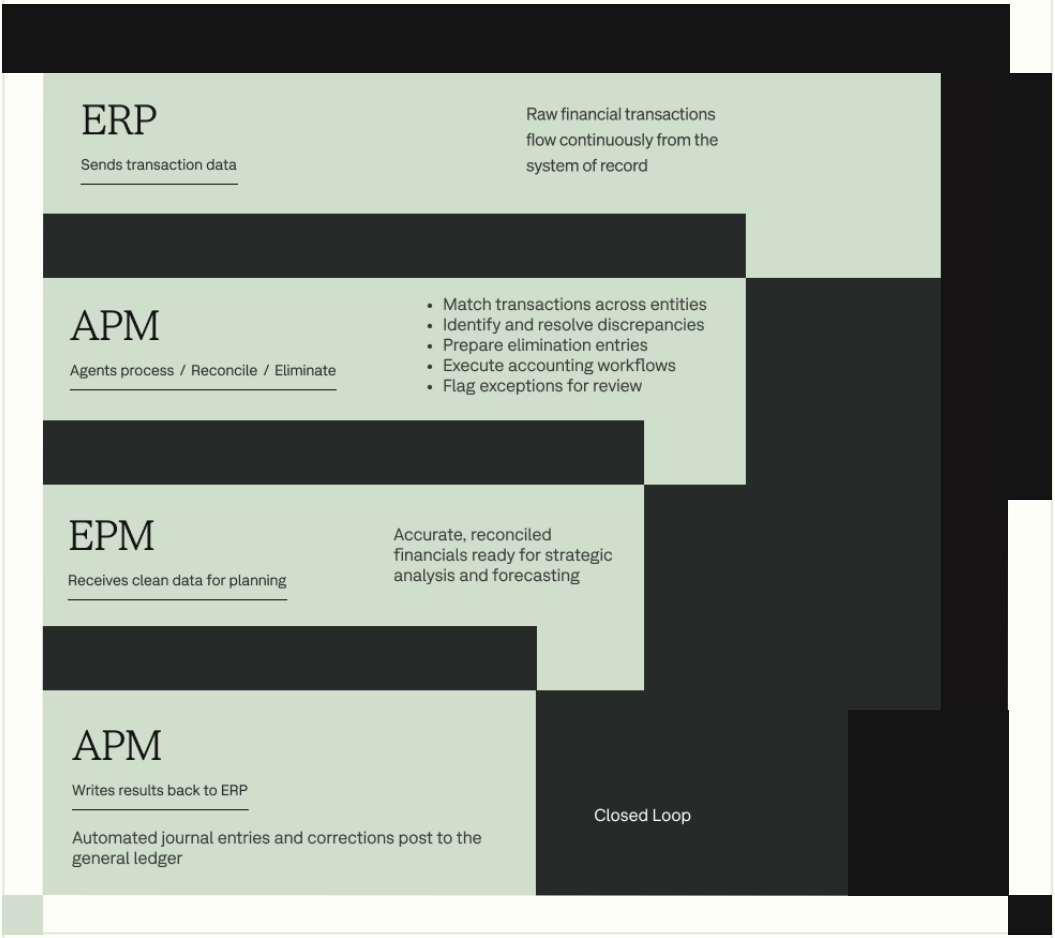
An intelligent, coordinated system of specialized AI agents that operates on top of existing ERPs to independently execute multi-step finance and accounting workflows with audit-ready traceability and human oversight.

How APM Creates the Execution Layer



Agentic Performance Management (APM) is a coordinated system of AI agents that can complete finance workflows from start to finish, escalating only true exceptions for human review.

Able to layer on top of any existing ERP, this model can operate across markets and currencies, providing full traceability and control while maintaining a close- and audit-ready state across entities.



APM does the manual and analytical work that traditionally lived in the "in-between" layer of accounting: matching, reconciliation, flux analysis, and other key workflows. Instead of requiring humans to execute tasks, interpret exceptions, and implement updates, the solution executes the work while finance leaders set thresholds and provide approvals.

For finance leaders, CFOs, and controllers, the value of agentic finance is not just reduced hours and increased speed, but expanded capacity. "APM is not just doing the same things faster, but things that couldn't be done by humans before," says Nominal VP of Product Management, Yaara Handel. That shift means finance leaders can spend more time on strategic work, and less on the manual and repetitive functions that have traditionally defined (and limited) finance and accounting.

Explore more on this topic:

Agentic Performance Management: The Next Step After Finance Automation (Nominal)

The future is here: companies can scale faster with Nominal's APM, growing revenue without expanding general and administrative spend. With APM, finance leaders can expect faster close times, improved audit readiness, greater reliability, and deeper clarity for the business.

Agentic Performance Management moves finance from a system of records to a system of intelligence.

How APM Will Transform Finance

Agentic Performance Management changes how finance teams operate, not by accelerating the same steps, but by executing accounting tasks constantly in real time, rather than

The Evolution to Agentic Performance Management

From manual coordination to autonomous execution

Before

Human-Dependent

Every step requires manual intervention, from data gathering to reconciliation to journal entries.

Batch Processing

Work happens in monthly cycles with teams dedicated to close for days at a time

Limited Automation

RPA and tools assist but break on exceptions. AI suggests but cannot execute

- **Close timeline:** 8-12 Days
- **Team Focus:** 85% Execution
- **Scalability:** Linear with account

After (APM)

Autonomous Execution

Agents complete entire workflows from validation to posting without waiting for input

Continuous Operations

Real-time processing throughout the month with instant visibility and no backlogs

Complete Workflows

Agents own reconciliations, consolidations, and closes end-to-end with built-in exception handling

- **Close timeline:** 1-3 Days
- **Team Focus:** 75% Strategy
- **Scalability:** Instant & Elastic

during intermittent end-of-period cycles. “APM can execute your accounting logic continuously. It’s always synced and execution ready,” says Katherine Meija, an account executive with Nominal.

Because finance agents run continuously, they can do work that is impractical for humans at scale, from full-population flux analysis across entities and ledgers to anomaly detection and pattern recognition across thousands of transactions and accounts. APM shifts finance from periodic, manual effort to continuous autonomous execution and oversight. It helps controllers and CFOs increase capacity, speed up the close, and redirect time towards strategic work that moves the bottom line.

Helpful resources:

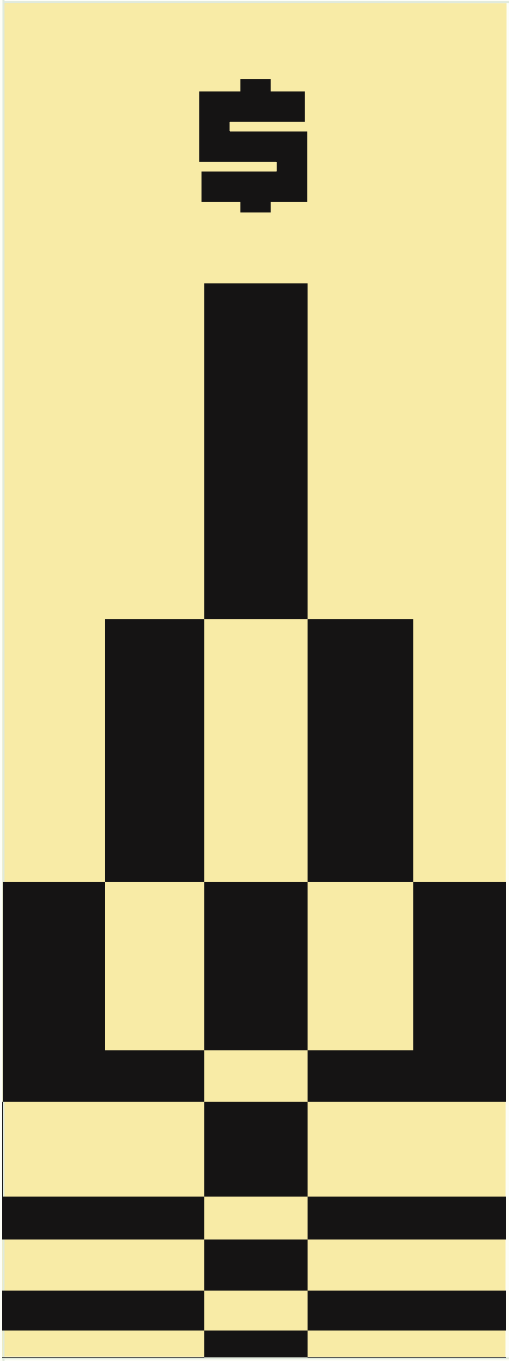
Deloitte.

AI and emerging tech’s impact on finance

KPMG

The future of FP&A with AI

Legacy tool	What it does	Why it fails at scale	Nominal's APM
RPA (robotic process automation)	Automates clicks and keystrokes via rigid rules. Accelerates repeatable steps, but cannot interpret context or own outcomes.	Automations fail when fields or processes change. Issues increase with transaction growth, pushing manual work back to humans.	APM agents operate on live data, apply contextual judgment, and complete workflows end-to-end while only escalating true exceptions.
Close management and task tools	Digitizes checklists and coordinates people. Tracks status, but humans still must do the work.	As complexity grows, checklists and coordination requirements expand. Progress tracking does not reduce the underlying manual work required.	Replaces orchestration with execution. Agents run matching, reconciliations, flux, and other workflows continuously.
Traditional consolidation software	Consolidates data after posting for reporting. Does not improve source data quality or readiness.	Consolidation happens after the fact, so errors and inconsistencies accumulate. More entities and systems create more adjustments and longer close cycles.	Continuously validates, reconciles, and explains data as it is created, improving reliability and results.
AI co-pilots and assistants	Help users ask questions, draft explanations, and explore data. Doesn't provide insights or recommendations and relies on humans to take action.	As transaction volume and entity count increase, so does the response and validation burden, limiting scalability.	Executes multi-step workflows, produces audit-ready documentation, and routes items to humans only for approval or judgment calls.



Turning Complexity Into Compounding Advantage

In a world that is rapidly integrating AI into crucial finance functions, inaction quietly locks in flawed processes and systems. Every month adds another layer of one-off fixes and spreadsheet workarounds. Each new entity, revenue stream, or policy adds incremental workload. Like interest on a debt, these inefficiencies compound over time. And when external expectations increase, whether from boards, auditors, investors, or acquirers, organizations that have not modernized end up paying the cost in multiple ways.

Conversely, smart finance leaders who invest in Agentic Performance Management early will see compounding advantages. APM can standardize how finance work is structured and executed, then apply those standards as the business expands. Agents monitor accounts, match and reconcile, and highlight anomalies with documentation attached.

The result is a finance function that can absorb growth and increasing complexity without reinventing the wheel (and the close) each quarter. By deploying this system sooner, teams standardize accounting practices earlier and build better frameworks. Revenue, entities, and volume can scale without proportional increases in costs and headcount.

Recommended read:

The CFO's Impossible Triangle (Nominal)



The Four Core Principles of APM

APM is the key that unlocks a fundamental change in the work of finance. At its core, it is designed to deliver outcomes, not just insights. The four core principles below explain how the system enables execution and scale across the finance function.



#1 Execution, not suggestions

APM agents don't just recommend next steps; they complete them. Controllers and finance leaders move from doers to reviewers, reserving human judgment for the decisions that actually require it.



#2 A continuous close that redefines "done"

APM turns "done" into a daily state, rather than a month-end moment. Agents validate, reconcile, and keep the books ready for the close in near real-time. The result is less month-end chaos, more confidence, and a system that is audit-ready by default.



#3 ERP-agnostic, multi-entity by design

Agentic Performance Management works across multiple ERPs, entities, and currencies without costly system implementation or re-platforming. The agent-based execution solution functions as a control tower that

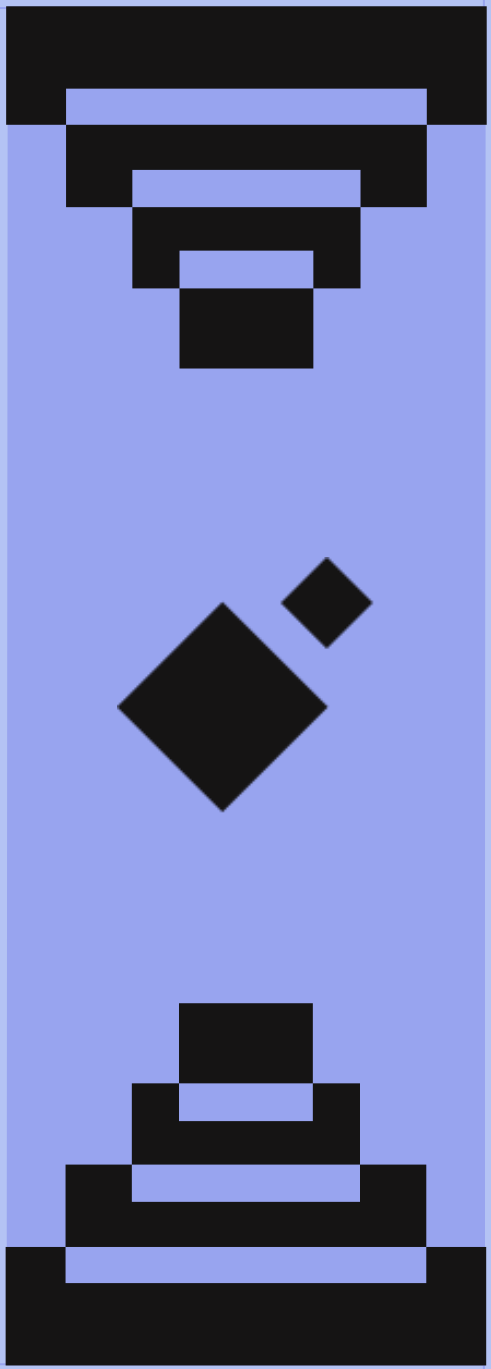
unifies fragmented frameworks and processes and delivers consistent outcomes.

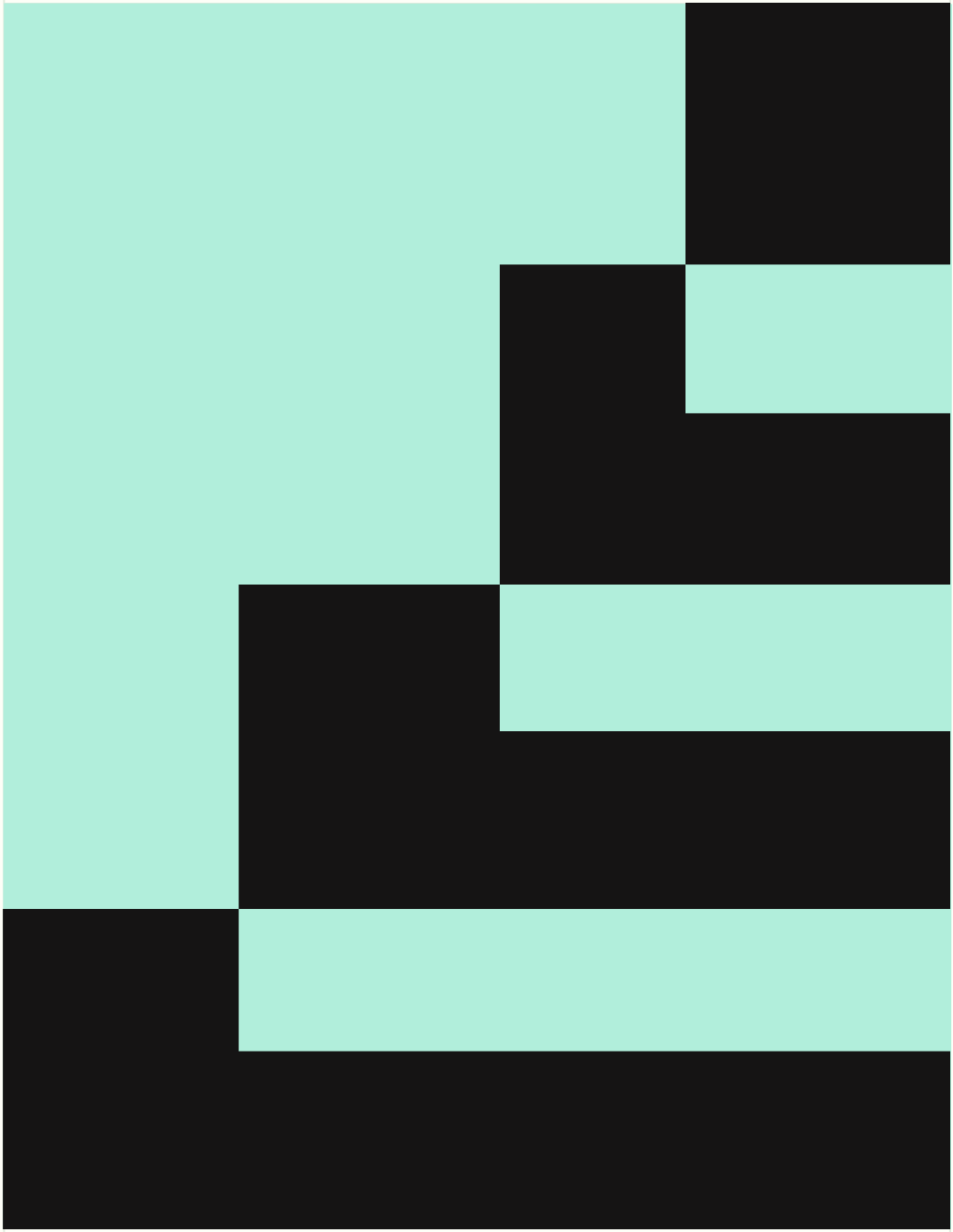
#4 Human-in-the-loop governance

Agentic Performance Management is built for governance and control with natural-language definitions, rules, and approval thresholds. Finance teams can specify when escalation is required, and can access full documentation at any time. Nominal's APM architecture is designed to support SOC 1 controls.

Learn more:

The Complete Guide to Close in 2026 (Nominal)





How to Use APM: Results That Scale

Agentic Performance Management creates a scalable operating model, turning finance workflows into fully executed processes. The seven use cases below provide concrete, actionable starting points that you and your team can implement to create quick wins for your business.

1. Continuous bank reconciliation, built into the close

The problem: The bank reconciliation process is still largely manual and time-intensive, especially for companies with multiple bank accounts. Errors and omissions often are undetected until the final close process or an audit identifies issues.

The APM transformation: Nominal transforms bank reconciliation into a continuous, automated workflow. Suggested adjustments are routed for review, then approved entries can be written back to the general ledger with full traceability. Agentic intelligence powers automated cash matching at scale while exceptions are uncovered in real time and routed to the right approver or workflow, leading to a faster, cleaner reconciliation.

The outcome: Reconciliation is no longer an onerous process of manual matching and investigation. The process shifts to a streamlined workflow of review, routing, and approval. Finance teams are freed from mechanical work so they can

focus on strategic contributions like analysis and decision support.

2.Transaction patrol and revenue protection

The problem: Revenue leakage from missed, misconfigured, or split transactions can hide in plain sight. Missed recurring entries, misclassification, duplicates, and policy violations (like splitting expenses to avoid approvals) often evade detection. Manual reviews often rely on sampling, potentially resulting in lost revenue and extra costs.

The APM transformation: APM agents continuously scan for missing, misclassified, or outlier activity. The solution can also identify patterns humans may not catch, like repeated under-billing for a customer or product, duplicate vendor invoices, or spend splitting to avoid approvals. When an exception hits, an agent-based execution system can provide the supporting context and create a recommended action for review and approval.

The outcome: Reduced revenue leakage and a decline in uncollected cash. Stronger enforcement of internal policies, with less manual policing and better policy enforcement.

3.Continuous close, redefining “done”

The problem: In the traditional close process, “done” is a moving target that finance teams reach only after days of work. Afterwards, the team operates

on stale numbers with limited visibility until the next close.

The APM transformation: With agentic finance, done is a daily occurrence, not a month-end moment. Agents run continuously, matching transactions, reconciling accounts, performing flux analysis, and flagging policy exceptions. Only true issues are escalated for human review, and the team has clear insight into what's been done and why.

The outcome: "Done" shifts from an after-the-fact checkpoint to a continuous system state. Teams make decisions with better data. The shift from periodic to continuous finance gives controllers real-time visibility into financial operations and frees teams to focus on strategy and analysis.



Case Study: APM in Action

Leanpay, a fast-growing Buy Now, Pay Later provider with entities in five countries, was closing and consolidating in Excel. The team was juggling entities, currencies, and intercompany accounting eliminations with limited visibility. Nominal's APM connected to Leanpay's ERP, created a daily data feed with automated mapping, consolidation, and multi-currency translation. The system also elevated oversights like unreversed accruals before close.

"With Nominal, we've cut at least two days from our close each

month, and we save weeks during our end-of-year consolidation," said Jan Grižon, Head of Finance. The time needed for month-end close fell 20–25%, and investor and bank data requests can now be answered in hours rather than days. Transparent, audit-ready reporting means fewer pre-meeting prep hours and more time for analysis.

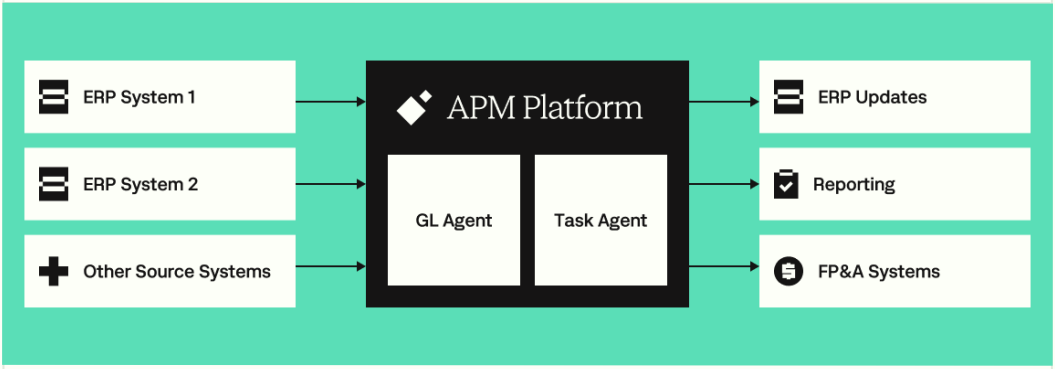
Learn more about Leanpay's journey

The Challenge:

Before Nominal, monthly and year-end consolidations were performed entirely in Excel. Each entity had its own workbook, linked to a separate consolidation file, plus a standalone intercompany eliminations file. This process was cumbersome, error-prone, and slow.

The Results:

- 25% faster month-end close
- Weeks saved during year-end consolidation
- Real-time transparency and drill-down capabilities
- Immediate answers to investor and bank queries



4. Trigger-based general ledger automation

The problem: Everyday events, like invoices, vendor bills, or cash receipts, still require manual follow-up actions. Tasks like reversing accruals, updating intercompany accounting entries, or variance analysis often lag or get missed.

The APM transformation: Trigger agents "listen" for ERP events, like vendor bills that require accrual reversals, and respond with recommended next steps the moment a relevant event hits the ledger. Tasks and recommendations are routed for review and approval, creating a system of execution for your ERP.

The outcome: Fewer dropped balls. Cleaner accruals and fewer post-close adjustments, with control, traceability and consistent execution built in.

5. Intercompany and multi-entity reconciliation at scale

The problem: Complex intercompany reconciliations can span hundreds of entities and multiple ERPs. Manual

matching, old email chains, and a lack of visibility into the books cause delays and bottlenecks. Mismatches and month-end close require follow-up across teams and time zones. As the number of entities grows, so does the problem.

The APM transformation: Agentic Performance Management agents reconcile high-volume intercompany transactions, matching activity automatically using instructions expressed in natural language. Agents flag discrepancies and show detailed context for both sides, including what changed, where it posted and what needs a fix, enabling faster resolution.

The outcome: Users see a dramatic reduction in intercompany accounting time. Teams grow their ability to support rapid multi-entity growth and mergers and acquisitions without back-office expansion.



Case Study: APM in Action

Green Street Power Partners (GSPP), a national solar energy developer, has multiple holding companies and funds, along with over 280 project entities. The finance team previously spent days each month untangling company activity across the structure and then consolidating it in Excel.“With Nominal, we’ve cut at least two days from our close each month untangling company activity across the structure and then

consolidating it in Excel.

With Nominal's APM, GSPP automated intercompany eliminations and multi-entity consolidation, while managing over 200 monthly transactions and improving real-time visibility for leaders. "Nominal consolidated everything with a click, saving us countless hours and keeping our books audit-ready," Controller Josh Ramos said. The team saved over 60 hours per month while scaling multi-entity reporting and streamlining month-end close automation.

Learn more about GSPP's journey

The Challenge:

In 2023, Green Street Power Partners (GSPP) found itself grappling with the limitations of Excel for managing its complex financial operations. As a national solar energy developer with multiple funds, holding companies, and project entities, GSPP's corporate structure demanded a more sophisticated solution for financial management and reporting.

The Results:

- 60+ hours saved monthly
- ASC 842 compliance
- Multi-entity consolidation
- Collaborative close management
- Real-time financial visibility

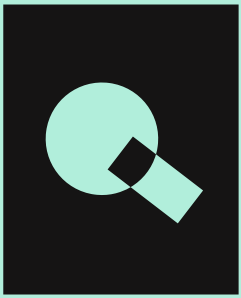
6. Deep-dive flux analysis on every account



The problem: Flux analysis can help teams identify meaningful period-to-period changes, but is often high-level, spotty, and retrospective. Teams cannot feasibly review every account, every period, at the transaction level.

The APM transformation: Flux agent runs full-population review across every account and entity, identifying key movements, drivers and anomalies. Instead of asking teams to explain "what changed," the agent-led execution layer performs variance analysis, tracing each exception back to the exact events that caused it, and then compares patterns against previous periods and baselines. The agents can surface likely root causes, attach the supporting documentation, and route true exceptions for human review and sign-off.

The outcome: Finance leaders get explanations grounded in transaction-level detail, and a higher confidence in reported results. Clear, transaction-backed explanations mean better, actionable insight for financial planning and analysis.

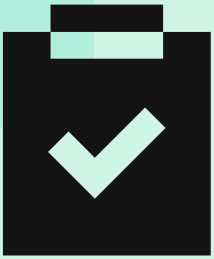


7. Audit and acquisition-ready by default

The problem: Internal audit is under-resourced, so issues surface late, often not until external auditors arrive. Audit prep becomes a fire drill involving spreadsheet archeology and email thread excavation. Prepping for a merger or acquisition requires hundreds of hours of manual work.

The APM transformation: Transaction patrol and policy agents monitor the ledger for missing, misclassified, or incorrect entries. Logs of each and every agent action and human approval include a complete audit trail and a traceable history. Teams can drill from any balance to its source in just a few clicks.

The outcome: The business is audit and acquisition-ready by default. Always-on APM means fewer surprises, lower compliance risk, and less hours for the team.



KUNAI

Case Study: APM in Action

Kunai, a fast-growing IT engineering consultancy targeting acquisition, needed buyer-ready financials. The company operated across multiple entities, currencies and ledgers, and needed to avoid a months-long ERP overhaul. Nominal's APM layered onto QuickBooks and Excel, mapped a 600-line P&L into an 18-line structure, and automated currency consolidation and intercompany eliminations.

Head of Finance Greg Hood said, "Nominal cut our time to acquisition and saved me an ERP implementation."

Over six months, Kunai saved an estimated 80 to 90 hours and avoided up to $20,000 in staffing and overtime costs. Nominal's Agentic Performance Management delivered GAAP-compliant, audit-ready reports that helped position the company for a successful acquisition.

Learn more about Kunai's journey

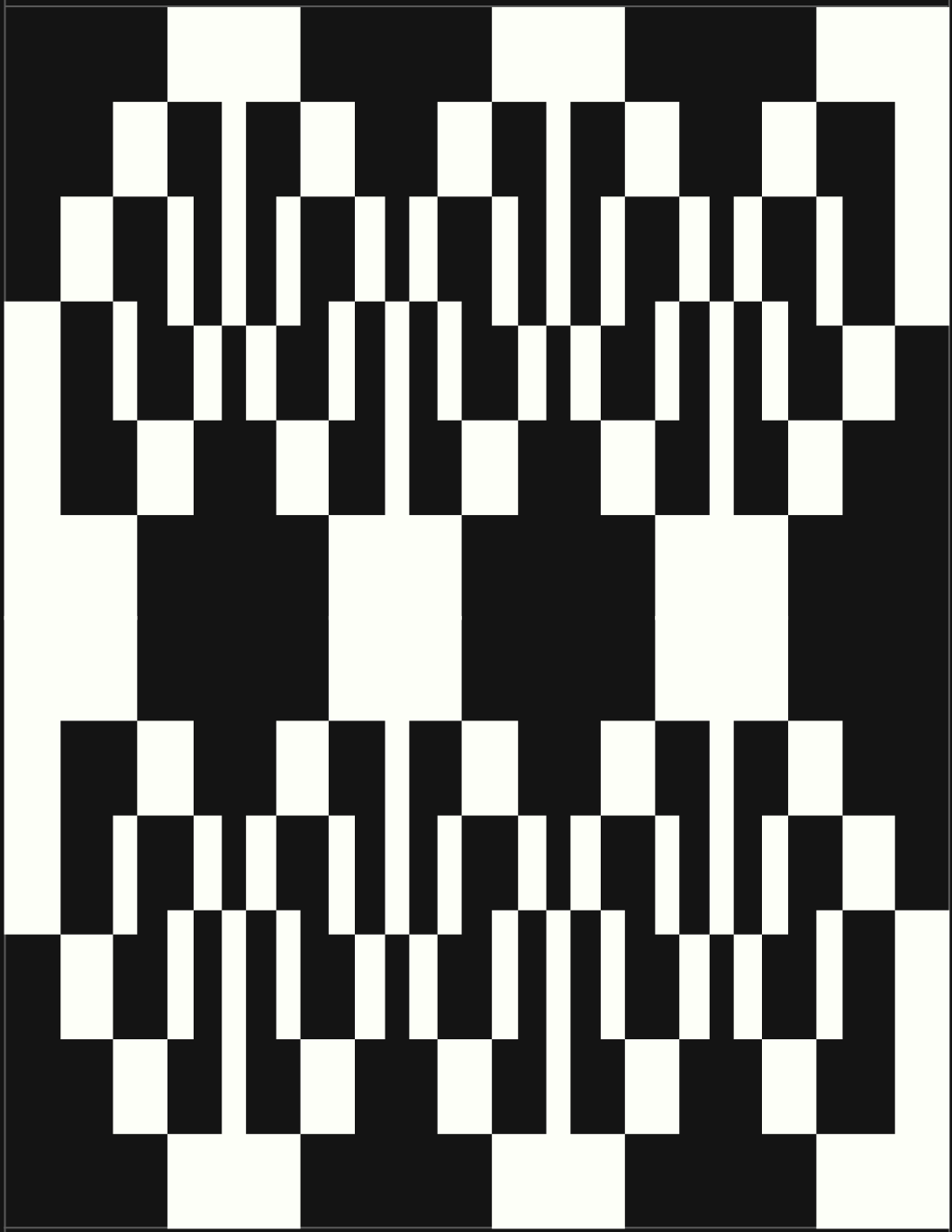
The Challenge:

Kunai's finance systems hadn't kept up with the expansion. The company had opened entities in multiple countries over the previous year, each with its own chart of accounts, systems, and currencies.

The web of spreadsheets and disconnected ledgers made even routine tasks a hassle. Month-end close took days, and an ERP migration would take months and cost a fortune. Kunai needed a fast, reliable way to consolidate its books, ensure GAAP compliance, and produce audit-ready reports without overhauling its entire tech stack.

The Results:

- 80+ hours saved in six months
- 75% of anomalies resolved automatically
- $20,000 saved in temporary staffing and overtime costs
- Nominal cut Kunai time to acquisition without an ERP implementation



Guardrails and Governance

In finance, trust is a prerequisite and controls and safeguards are non-optional. Nominal's APM agents operate inside a defined set of rules, including definitions and discrepancy thresholds. Agents are configured in natural language, codifying internal safeguards, policies, and standards in a way that teams can review and align on.

Policies, thresholds, and approvals are integrated as transparent controls, creating accountability and trust at every step. Every action includes documentation and an audit trail, so actions are explainable and defensible. Human reviewers can approve, reject, or refine results to maintain accountability, all within the context of SOC 1-compatible controls.

Learn more:

Trust is a key factor in agentic AI adoption and usage (Deloitte)

How to Separate APM From Look-Alike Tools

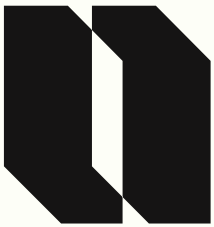
"AI-powered" can mean anything. Here's some guidance on how to assess what a system can actually do, and separate true APM from imitator platforms and tools. The questions and red flags below are a starting point to help you pressure-test operating models and dig into what the solution can actually execute.

Key Questions:

- **Execution vs. suggestion**: In a demo, insist on clarity around who does the work. Do the AI assistants just create suggested actions for review or actually execute complete workflows?
- **Architecture**: Validate whether the solution has true ERP-agnostic connectivity and multi-entity support, so the platform can scale as complexity grows. Ask how it will connect to your current tech stack. Will the solution require a transition to a new ERP?
- **Governance**: Look for configurable, rules-based agents, clear reviewer sign-off, and end-to-end traceability. How are agents configured? Can your team easily trace and audit agent actions? Is there a clear separation between the AI preparer and the human reviewer?

Red Flags:

- **"AI-powered" tools that are really just rules engines**: If it only routes tasks, but cannot fully execute automated reconciliations, eliminations, and workflows, the tool is just a coordinator, not Agentic Performance Management.
- **Copilots that cannot connect to the general ledger or execute work**: If humans must touch every transaction, effort and manual work will continue increasing alongside business growth.
- **Heavy professional services dependency**: If every new entity, policy, or workflow requires ongoing customization, you are buying services instead of a scalable system.



Helpful resources:

Compare Nominal's APM to other solutions

Nominal

APM Evaluation Checklist: Core APM Capabilities vs. Market Look-Alikes

Capability	Nominal's Agentic Performance Management	"Look-alikes" and red flags to watch for
Execution versus suggestions	Agents complete workflows from end to end, escalating only true exceptions for review and sign-off.	Tools that surface insights or complete one-off tasks, but leave execution to humans.
Writes back to the general ledger	Agents can execute tasks and write to the general ledger with approval, not just coordinate work.	Copilots that cannot connect to the general ledger, or that stop at recommendations.
Continuous execution	An always-synced model that runs continuously and keeps books close-ready.	Tools that run only at close or need manual review.
Human-in-the-loop governance	Explicit approvals, thresholds, and escalation rules. Humans review and approve; agents prepare and execute.	Automation with unclear controls, approval steps, or escalation paths.
Audit trail and traceability	Traceable actions with documentation and approvals.	Outputs without clear audit trails or transaction-level support.
ERP-agnostic connectivity	Works across ERPs, including legacy systems, without requiring a migration.	Tools limited to a short ERP list, or that require replatforming.

Capability	Nominal's Agentic Performance Management	"Look-alikes" and red flags to watch for
Multi-entity and multi-currency support	Built for multi-entity operations, including consolidation and intercompany workflows. Supports multi-currency environments.	Single entity tools that add multi-entity support later.
Configurable agent logic	Natural language configuration to adapt workflows without external services.	Rule engines that require paying external support or consultants for routine changes.
Full population patrol	Continuous scanning for missing, misclassified, and out-of-policy activity across full populations.	Sampling-based checks portrayed as continuous monitoring.
Transaction-backed flux analysis	Full population analysis with supporting documentation.	High-level dashboards without drill-down or documentation.
Trigger-based automation	Responds to ERP events such as payments and bills as they post.	Scheduled or script-based automation that cannot act on live events.
Workflow execution	Fully executes reconciliations and workflows, not just task-tracking.	Checklist tools that track work but do not execute it.



Leading the Future With Agentic Performance Management

The organizations that win in the era of artificial intelligence won't be the ones that "use AI." They'll be the ones operationalizing it, leveraging a system that allows humans to steer and strategize while APM takes the manual, repetitive tasks off the plate.

The outcomes are clear and measurable. Finance leaders will gain capacity, not just speed. They get better numbers, fewer surprises, and less risk. The space to plan, strategize, and make better decisions.

Agentic Performance Management is how leading controllers and CFOs will leverage AI as an execution partner that can do the work, shifting the finance function from periodic, manual effort to continuous execution and oversight. The result? Scale without proportional growth in finance function costs.

The future of finance is here. The only question is whether your organization will lead it or fall behind.

Explore more on this topic:

McKinsey & Company

The Agentic Organization

Forbes

Empowering Finance: Integrating Agentic AI Into The Talent Model (Forbes)



Learn More About Nominal's APM

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